



Furman Student Organization Advisor Guidelines

The Student Organization Advisor is an integral part of the daily operation of any organization. The advisor should be Furman University faculty or staff member and should strive to assist the student members of the organization in conducting the daily and ongoing business of their particular group.

The ultimate goal of a student organization advisor is to assist in the *growth* and *development* of students through the function of their club or organization. While students are primarily responsible for the actions associated with any Furman University registered/sponsored student organization, the advisor of that organization should take all necessary steps to ensure that students follow University protocol at all times. Specific responsibilities, expectations, and benefits include the following:

RESPONSIBILITIES (Overarching, general responsibilities as an advisor)

- ❖ Develop the leadership skills of organization members and leaders
- ❖ Provide comprehensive direction and guidance as the students plan projects and events
- ❖ Serve as a resource to all members
- ❖ Assess and maintain risk management and financial management practices
- ❖ Participate in staff training, events and meetings
- ❖ Ensure that the organization adheres to all university and Student Government Association (SGA) policies and procedures

EXPECTATIONS (Basic expectations of an advisor at Furman)

- ❖ Meet with the executive board and attend meetings and/or events, especially those that may potentially have liability/risk for the institution
- ❖ Understand and communicate institutional policies/procedures
- ❖ Provide risk management and financial management guidance
- ❖ Provide continuity for the organization from year to year
- ❖ Act as a comprehensive resource for the group
- ❖ Report knowledge of illegal activity or activities contrary to Furman University policy to University Police or Student Life
- ❖ Pursuant to the Cleary Act, serve as a mandatory reporter if any person reveals that they have been the victim, witness and/or perpetrator of any incident that might involve crime
- ❖ Have fun!

BENEFITS (What's in it for you?)

- ❖ Work closely with and mentor students outside of the office, classroom, or normal routine
- ❖ Share knowledge and experience in specific areas of interest
- ❖ Assist a group of students to develop as a team and accomplish its goals
- ❖ Encourage students as they work to carry out the mission of their group and contribute positively to the Furman community



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Student Group: PHOKUS

Advisor Name: Sandra Adams

Advisor Expectations Checklist

The chart below outlines some expectations for student leaders and advisors to create a mutually agreed upon advisor role (keeping the general expectations in mind). The advisor and the officers of the organization should rank the items using numbers 1-5 (1-4 being a scale of the advisor role, 5 if the item is more of a student duty). Officers may complete the checklist and then discuss with advisor if preferred. For items determined not to be the responsibility of the advisor, it is important to decide who has that responsibility.

Rating System

1. Essential duty
2. Occasional duty, helpful
3. Optional duty, nice but not necessary
4. Not an advisor role
5. Exclusive student role

1	Attend all general meetings
3	Attend all executive committee meetings
1	Take an active part in formulating the goals of the group
1	Take the initiative in developing teamwork and cooperation among the officers
5	Call meetings of the executive committee when believed to be necessary
2	Attend all group activities and events
2	Meet with the chief student leader before each meeting
5	Help the chief student leader or other officers prepare an agenda before each meeting
2	Be quiet during the general meetings unless called upon
2	Speak up during discussion when the advisor thinks the group may make a poor decision
2	Exert influence with officers between meetings

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2	Initiate ideas for discussion when the advisor believes they will be helpful to the group
1	Be one of the group, except for voting and holding office
1	Veto a decision when it violates a stated objective, the bylaws, or University policy
5	Check the secretary's minutes before they are written in final form
5	Check all official correspondence before it is sent
1	Get a copy of all official correspondence
1	Inform the group of infractions of their bylaws, codes, and standing rules
1	Recommend programs, speakers, etc.
1	Make the group aware of its stated objectives when planning events
2	Cancel any activities when you believe they have been inadequately planned, will violate University rules, or are unsafe
2	Insist on an evaluation of each activity by those students responsible for planning it
2	Let the group thrive or decline on its own; do not interfere unless requested
2	Let the group work out its problems; allow for mistakes and "doing it the hard way"
1	Represent the group in any conflicts with members of the University staff
1	Be familiar with University resources and procedures that affect group activities
1	Explain University policy when relevant to the discussion
4	Explain University policy to the entire group once a year
1	Depend on the officers to observe University policy throughout their terms
5	Be a custodian of all group paraphernalia, records, etc. during the summer and between officer transitions
1	Keep the official files of the organization
1	Request to see the treasurer's books at the end of each semester
1	Take an active part in the orderly transition of responsibilities between old and new officers at the end of the year



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Advisor Signature: Sandra Adams RN

Organization Officer Signature: Emily Sandlin

Date: 1/12/18